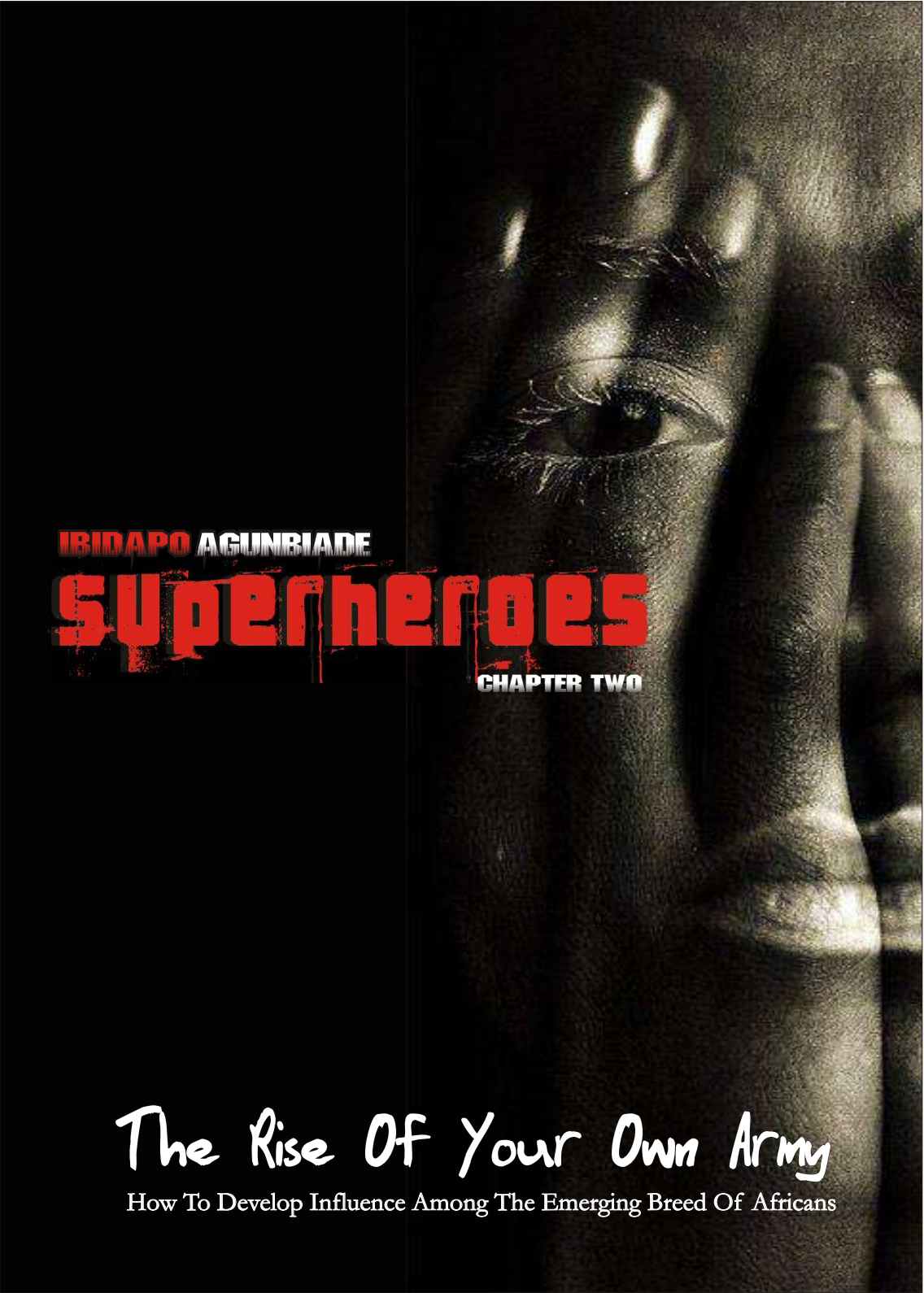


IBIDAPO AGUNBIADE

Superheroes

CHAPTER TWO

The Rise Of Your Own Army

How To Develop Influence Among The Emerging Breed Of Africans



superheroes

The Rise Of Your Own Army

CHAPTER TWO

Hello Dear Friend,
I do not believe that you are reading this chapter by accident; whether you received it as a gift, picked it up at a restaurant or the airport kiosk, or downloaded it from www.superheroes.co.nr, this chapter found you. It found you for good reason. There is a powerful force at work in your life that will allow you to develop your life, career and business. Honor that force and use the knowledge contained in this chapter to develop awesome influence. Tomorrow, you will need it.
You might ask, will these work? To which my answer is summed up in one word - absolutely.

P.s. if it doesn't work, i'll be glad to refund the N 0,000 you paid for this chapter.Enjoy

Ibidapo Agunbiade
Executive Partner, DMA

Evening. 22nd May 1941

Thunder exploded upon the ship. The rain came down in bucketfulls. The ship rocked wildly and dangerously from side to side. It threatened to capsize. A very cold storm blew fiercely across the shivering men on board and goosebumps appeared on their dark skin. The young men sat in two groups in the rain with their hands and feet chained down to the deck. The two groups stared across at each other in confusion being drenched heavily in the atlantic rain.

Then horror struck. Hell opened its gates and out came the huge giants. The same huge giants that had shaved the young men's heads. They re-emerged with matchets in their hands and approached the first group with a demonic grin on their face. The other group watched in horror as wrists and feet were initially cut off. The blood mixed with the rain and stained the bodies left. A teenage boy attempted to stand after his hands were cut. The matchet came down and chopped off his head. The head fell down with a large thud and rolled to and fro as the ship rocked from side to side. The men were too shocked to cry. They tried to resist in futility. The matchets came down on their abdomen and intestines were spilled on the deck. One of the giants reached into another teenage boy's abdomen and tore out the intestines. He inched his fingers inward until he clawed at the right kidney. He yanked out the kidney and took a deep bite from it- savouring the taste with relish. The boy looked down in horror as his kidney was eaten. The blood drained from the kidney down the giants bloodstained teeth and lips down the neck. As he took another bite into the kidney, the teenager's body shook reflexly and the arms and legs were thrown into seizures. He could not cry. Another giant pulled out a suya-stick like object and plunged it into a captive's eye. The captive yelled out, aaaaaahhhhhh". A yellowish smelly liquid oozed out. The giant bent over smiling. He dropped the stick and using both hands to stabilize the head, he slowly sucked out the yellowish ooze from the eye. Then he proceeded to pluck out the second eye carefully. The captive screamed in excruciating pain.One by one, the bodies were thrown overboard until the first group was gone. The fishes would never forget that day. Neither would Yunus Von A.

XXX

24hours earlier. 21st May 1941. 8P.M.

Dark night. The moon did not give its light. A Southeast Atlantic wind blew across what would later become TinCan Island/ Roro Port in Apapa, Lagos- Nigeria. It blew some dust into the eyes of a young man who had come to the port in search of employment. His interview was to hold the next morning. Little did he know that tonight would forever alter the course of his life. He was at the entrance of the Port. It was about 7pm. He had just walked a little less than a hundred metres through the Port gate when a Voice rang out.
'Halt", the deep voice boomed. He stopped and turned around slowly. Very slowly.
It was dark. He could not see clearly. He saw the outline of a weapon. A gun was pointed at him. A gun? he thought. Fear gripped him. He panicked. An object hit his head from behind.He fell down. Unconscious.

19th December 2005. 2A.M.
Sagamu, Ogun State Nigeria. My Apartment.

Darkness prevailed upon me. Total Blackout. I awoke with a start.It wasn't the first time I had woken up ominously. It wouldn't be the last. I had a premonition that something was about to happen. Something was wrong. I lay in the Dark eyes open. I stared ahead. Slowly, my eyes got accustomed to the Darkness. I saw in the dark.

A dark fuzzy object came into view. A hand. A dark hand in black leather gloves. I froze in the Dark. A tiny voice sounded in my head. "Don't trust your reflexes "

A death grip tightened around my mouth slightly covering my lips. "Get up", a deep guttural voice sounded. Fear registered in my mind. I almost defaecated in my boxers. The stench of soon-to-be-released faeces filled my bedroom.
"What on earth is going...."
"shh...", the voice said

I looked around. There were three of them. All in black leather jackets.In the dark, one of them motioned me to stand.I stood up. My door was opened and we walked out. "Where on earth are we going?", crossed through my mind.We walked into my livingroom and through the main entrance of my apartment building onto the main street. A dark lexus was parked in front of my residence- engines purring silently. The driver came down and draped me in a dark flowing robe to cover my half nudity.
I was ushered into the car and we drove off. Several thoughts went through my mind." would they touch my family? Fear gripped me the more- I was scared shit. I began to pray silently, but then remembered.

XXX

11 pm. 21st May 1941
A ship had left the shores of Lagos. Onboard had been over 500 passengers enroute to Gold Coast. All unconscious. None aware of the destination. None aware of the purpose. Yunus Von A was on board- almost dead.

XXX

4 am. 19th December 2005.
The Outskirts of Nowhere. The Lexus slowed up to halt in front of a large residence housed on several acres of land. The gates were made of polished wrought iron. It imposed and glowed. There were bright floodlights everywhere. The lights seemed to glow from within the house- perimeter lights. Closed circuit surveillance systems. Motion sensors. Body heat monitors. "Whoever lives here must be rich, really rich", I said to myself. The Gates opened and the lexus eased into the grounds. I studied the layout- Impressive architecture. The grounds were obviously well planned.
A butler approached the lexus. He opened the door and bowed to me. "Sir, HE awaits."

A thought passed through my mind,"who is the HE that awaits" The giant doors swung open. The bright lights blinded me. It was then I knew this wasn't a dream. My fears had finally caught up with me.

9 am. 22nd May 1941 Onboard a ship sailing the atlantic.

The whiteman looked at the men. All unconscious. He ruffled his eyebrows in deep thought. He needed to separate the weak from the strong. Few minutes passed. Then he knew exactly what to do. Walking past two tall giants who stood like sentinels guarding the entrance of the deck, he went down the whitewashed staircase into his brightly lit cream-walled cabin room. Only one thought was on his mind- he would need to ruin a pillow to get some feathers.

XXX

4 am. 19th December 2005
The Light Filled residence on The Outskirts of Nowhere.
I was walked through the large doors and down a long hallway to what was a large boardroom. The doors swung open of their own volition. I stepped in and the door shut silently behind me. I looked down the boardroom and saw a huge chair turned facing the wall, its occupant mysteriously silent. All of a sudden, I knew I could NOT sit down. I just knew. Out of respect to this gentleman who had summoned me at this time of the night, I remained
standing.

The chair didn't turn towards me. However a voice filled the entire boardroom. It seemed to come from the chair.

"Young man, I've been observing your progress for some time now. I must say I'm impressed with your use of unconventional material resources to achieve your goals but you're grossly underutilising the human resources around you." he said

"You're crawling at snail speed. If you don't make use of the human resources around you, you'll be long dead before you the purpose of your existence" he continued

I stammered out the words..."Sir...sir...sir, I don't know you..."

"That doesn't matter. I know you and I've been observing you with some form of interest."

"sir, I'm sorry if I have offended you but ..."

He cut me off. "You're here. I don't waste words. Listen - I could have spoken to you in your room but I wanted to ensure that you won't forget. Several before you have forgotten and are living their lives as if they own it. There will be days you will question your memory but this meeting will remind you."

He stretched his index finger towards the wall facing me. A familiar face appeared on the wall. I recognised it instantly
"I believe you've met this man", he said .Met that man? I've more than met that man.
"You need to speak to him. There's a lot for you to learn. Now go."

11 am. 22nd May 1941

Yunus Von A. woke up with a start. His brown khaki shirt was bloodstained. Blood had caked at the back of his head. He looked around him and saw confusion written on the faces of everyone onboard. Some were crying and wailing in their native dialect. Some were singing death songs. He braced himself and muttered under his breath, "I will survive this. I will see my family again". It was an attitude he would pass onto his seed.

XXX

19th December 2005. 6am . My Apartment.

I woke up in my bed. Then I was confused. I couldn't confide in anyone. Nobody would believe me. I knew EXACTLY what I needed to do.

XXX

12 noon. 22nd May 1941. The scorching sun stared down on the ship. Kpa! Kpa! Kpa! Bottles being broken onboard the ship called Lord Lugard IV. Yunus Von A. looked in the direction of the sounds. It seemed to come from beneath the ship. A fresh wave of wailing and cries broke out amongst the men onboard. Tall, Dark and muscular giants with bulging muscles and dangerous looking sixpacks appeared mysteriously from beneath the deck wielding broken bottles in one hand and a whip in the other. They started seizing hold of the young men one at a time and flogged them. They then proceeded to shave their heads with the sharp edges of the broken bottles. From beneath the deck, the tall lanky whiteman observed the events with a tiny glint of amusement in his eyes.

XXX

The next day I paid the man a visit. A visit that almost cost me my life.

XXX

2pm 22nd May 1941

"Everybody Undress!", the whiteman shouted.
Interpreters translated into the various languages and dialects.The tall lanky whiteman smiled as they all scrambled to strip naked. Yunus Von A. stepped out of his khaki shirts and trousers. He looked around and saw on board the ship were countless Nigerian men of varying ages all standing nude in the hot sun. "Lie prostrate!", the whiteman barked out obviously enjoying himself. With humiliation and shame boldly written on the faces of the men, they lay prostrate on the floor with their genitals dangling on the scorching hot deck. What was to follow was an even greater form of humiliation. The same tall dark giants who had shaved their heads earlier now proceeded to tickle their scrotum with chicken feathers. The same feathers were used from man to man. Some of the men managed to have an erection despite the scorching sun. What they never knew was this- It would not be the first time an erection would determine the fate of a generation.

I grew up around the man whose picture had been on the wall until my early teens. I watched him conduct his business, attend extended-extended family meetings, become successful and influential and eventually preside over his own court. I walked with him several times (as a kid) to his fishing village on the outskirts of Lagos, Nigeria and smiled as he spoke of influence, riches and loyalty. I listened to his story about his journey from unknown messenger boy to soldier and eventually to head his own tribal territory. I heard him speak about money and dealing with dubious Africans who would doublecross you if given the chance. I also saw the glint of pride in his eyes when he spoke of loyalty and honour - two concepts that are virtually nonexistent in today's money-obssessed generation.

In this chapter,we examine the rise and fall of various supermen from obscurity to influence and the wars they fight on their way to global significance. These chapter contains superhero stories of how we do NOT develop influence alone but as a part of a much larger community. The stories are NOT for just the emerging business leader, it is for the young student who is clueless about the future, the aspiring politician, the career technocrat and the African who dreams of global influence. These are the legends between me and the man on the wall who you will come to know very shortly. These are not just our legends alone, they can become yours also.

To rephrase my granpa's words -'In the forthcoming battles you will engage in, your strength and wisdom alone will fail you'

XXX

Evening
22nd May 1941

Thunder exploded upon Lugard IV. The rain came down in bucketfulls. The ship rocked wildly and dangerously from side to side. It threatened to capsize. A very cold storm blew fiercely across the shivering men on board and goosebumps appeared on their dark skin. The young men sat in two groups in the rain with their hands and feet chained down to the deck. The two groups stared across at each other in confusion being drenched heavily in the Atlantic rain. Then horror struck. Hell opened its gates and out came the huge giants. They marched over to where the captives sat chained to the deck. One of the giants reached into a teenage boy's abdomen and tore out the intestines. He inched his fingers inward until he clawed at the right kidney. He yanked out the kidney and took a deep bite from it- savouring the taste with relish. The boy looked down in horror as his kidney was eaten. The blood drained from the kidney down the giants bloodstained teeth and lips down the neck. As he took another bite into the kidney, the teenager's body shook reflexly and the arms and legs were thrown into seizures. He could not cry. Another giant pulled out a suya-stick like object and plunged it into a captive's eye. The captive yelled out,"aaaaaaaahhhhhh". A yellowish smelly liquid oozed out. The giant bent over smiling. He dropped the stick and using both hands to stabilize the head, he slowly sucked out the yellowish ooze from the eye. Then he proceeded to pluck out the second eye carefully. The captive screamed in excruciating pain.One by one, the bodies were thrown overboard until the first group was gone.

65 years later

I drove into the premises of the man whose picture had been on the wall. I had just left a meeting with a very demanding outsource partner and I just had to see the old man before I crashed at a friend's apartment at Omole Phase Two and locked myself up for a weekend of rest. (I'm a bachelor, you understand. I dare not try that if I'm married). As I parked the car, my phone rang. It was Miss Adegoke, our Office Administrator. More stressful news. My visions of a relaxing weekend evaporated with the news she delivered. My phone died just as the call ended. I came down from the vehicle and walked into the main entrance of his cream and scarlet-red coloured bungalow. The door of his livingroom was ajar and light streamed out onto the corridor. I walked in and prostrated.

"Good evening sir", I said in my native yoruba tongue.

My Granpa looked up from his cushion. He was a shadow of his previous years, the only surviving male in his lineage of the Family. In his prime, he had stood tall and proud. But now, he was shrunken in stature. However, the hard glint in his eyes were still there. It would remain throughout his battle with Old age.

Today's meeting held in his livingroom at Lagos, Nigeria. His livingroom was a Boardroom. Men seeking wisdom came for consultation. Those seeking power sought his audience. Those seeking justice prostrated before him. He was Judge, Attorney and Executioner. If I didn't know better, My Granpa- the czar was a god whom men respected and almost worshipped.

Tonight, a middle aged man lay prostrate before Granpa in tears. He must have been crying for about an hour. His life was coming to an end and he came to one man he knew could give him hope. He came to the czar for justice which the courts had denied him. His action which would eventually lead my granpa ending a 40year old friendship with a cheiftain that had been his childhood friend.

Our conversation had started from the medal of honour hanging on the wall of his livingroom. He reminisced briefly about his short career in the army, the ministry and then in private entreprise and tribal leadership.It had been one of those rare occassions that I had managed to escape from my busy schedule at my audience firm- Darkpore Media Africa to visit him.

He spoke, "Modern education deceives us that we can achieve success alone if we work hard enough. Nothing could be farther from the truth. We don't achieve success alone. We achieve success if we have had the right support around us at crucial moments."

"Granpa, I'm not sure I agree totally with you", I had replied
He continued." I'm sure that you know people who were very hardworking back in school but didn't amount to much because they didn't have the support of an understanding family. On the other hand, there are seemingly stupid people who made headway because they knew people who gave them a chance."

I nodded in response,"yes there are people like that, but not in all cases granpa. Most people have to start from the scratch and keep scratching"

He looked at me, smiled and said," Omode lo n se e (meaning- you're still thinking like a child). Nobody can achieve anything without support from an army of individuals, friends, family and associates. O le lati ori apata dide.(It is difficult to arise from a bare rock) The first lesson you need to learn in your search for success in business, politics, career is this- A lot depends on the army you have, the people you can influence and the people they can influence on your behalf. Eniyan Laso (people are your clothing) and they are more important than money. The foolish man chases money, the wiseman builds key relationships and uses the relationships to achieve his means including getting money."
I scratched my head in slight confusion."Granpa, but you need money to build any relationship in Nigeria. People will not want to associate with you if you don't have money"

Granpa smiled at me again. He was enjoying my dilemma. He then proceeded to ask me a series of questions along this line, " Did Adedibu have money before he became the strongman of Nigerian politics? Did Obasanjo have money when he joined the army? What about the young Aliko Dangote, did he have money when he set out to start selling rice?"

I sat silent before him. How could I answer his question, I was not with those men when they started out. I only knew where I stood when I started my audience brokering firm. It had been hell getting start-up financing.

"I don't know granpa", I said. I didn't like the trend this conversation was taking. If I wasn't careful, I would spend another seven hours hearing my granpa's war stories all over again.

He continued," That is exactly where your Generation has missed it. You assume money is the most important thing in getting results. Because of your faulty thinking, you refuse to develop the key relationships that can catapault you into success and then you grumble when you lose out to someone who has cultivated his own relationships. Awolowo didn't start out with money, he started out with great relationships. If you learn how to build great relationships, nothing will be impossible for you. All those men I mentioned earlier didn't start out with any significant advantage, they had to develop it along the way. Here's the twist, you can build an army of people who can support each other if you start out early enough."

I sat silent. I didn't know what to say. I was thinking about how to apply his insight into my immediate reality.
" I see you don't agree with me. Alright, let's start with you. When you decided to start out your firm, what was the first thing you did?", he asked

I remained silent. How was I supposed to tell my granpa that I never intended starting a firm. I just stumbled into it.

"You got a partner, abi?", he asked.
"Yes, I did sir"
"you both approached your folks for start up funds, abi?"
“yes, but..."
Shh... when your parents invested in your business, what do you think crossed their minds", he asked. I was silent.

"Do you think they thought you would become the next Rockefeller, heh?" He laughed a belly laugh almost falling off the chair.

"They didn't invest in your business. They invested in their relationship with you." "you are succeeding because your family supported you in addition to your being smart. Not because you knew exactly what to do. Several others don't have that support. Try and imagine the hell they'll be going through”

" I still go through hell running my firm, granpa. "

"That is usual. But imagine how much hell it would have been if you had no support. Not too pretty to imagine, heh?."

"Granpa, relationships are important. But in today's rapid world, there’s just no time. Perhaps much later", I said

"I'm no expert. But I will tell you what has worked for me. Tonight we'll lay the groundwork. Tomorrow, we'll go over the basics and when next we see, we'll discuss very simple strategy. What I will tell you is common sense, but very few people apply it.”

XXX

Evening. 22nd May 1941

The giants turned and faced the next group. Yunus Von A. looked up from the chains that held his feet down to the deck. He looked upwards into the cloudy evening sky, a sad smile appearing from the corner of his lower lips. A chant welled up from within him. A chant welled up and broke forth from his lips... He chanted slowly and sadly to the tune of a Yoruba Negro-spiritual death song. Slowly and gently, the chant spread from one man's lip to another and moved from heart to heart. The skies joined in the chant and the tears from heaven gushed down even more. The men would soon follow his lead across an entire continent.

He stepped out. The tall lanky whiteman. He stepped out and stopped. stopped and smiled at the chanting group. what he did not tell them was that the weak had been sacrificed. and that those chanting now would fight the war. They had been saved by their erection. But not for long. They were soon to find out when they sailed into the Gold Coast. Those who had been killed rejoiced when they looked down from hell and saw the fate that would befall their compatriots.

65 years later
Granpa's residence.
Laying the groundwork.

1. Delay is Dangerous...
When I was a messenger boy in the ministry, my nickname was **Delay is dangerous...** That was because I always ran to deliver parcels when sent. In those days, there was no speedpost, DHL or email. All the ministry relied was on Messenger boys. My nickname then also applies to the situation now. When it comes to building your own army, delay is dangerous. The president of tomorrow is just a small boy today. What benefit would it be to you if you could influence that small boy before he became president? That was the key to my influence. Identifying and building relationships with emerging Public figures. A problem several professionals like accountants, lawyers and doctors face is that they spend too much of their life studying technical things and forget to concentrate on developing their people skills. Much later in life they find themselves being governed by an unschooled politician who has honed his people skills perfectly. The greatest tyrants of history emphasized relationships. Hitler was great with a crowd. Stalin was good with people. What about Adedibu- you get the picture?"

2. Relationships are key.
Around you are people who might not seem most-likely-to-suceed but their life is headed for global domination. If you do NOT build meaningful relationships with them now, you might miss out on global influence tomorrow.

3. The need for volunteers
Everything you will do in life, you will need volunteers. You will have to learn how to find them, how to recruit them and how to empower them. Volunteers are key to influence. Your ability to get everyday people to associate their destiny with yours without coercing or forcing them. Even with your staff, you need to tap into their volunteer spirit. You can NOT pay a man enough to motivate him.

4. The rise of your army
A crucial key to global influence lies in the rise of your army. Not the strength but the rate at which your army grows and learns. An army is like a muscle. The more you build and train them, the better they become. You will need to find and equip people [superheroes] one by one. Because the day will come when you will need them. By then it will be too late to go back and build the relationships"

" Ibidapo, There's an army of superheroes to raise and empower, wealth to be acquired and a nation of supermen to be built. But we will continue our stories later, It is already late tonight. *Omo tabiire kin fi oru rin* (a responsible son does not walk about late at night)
"Good night, granpa", I prostrated before him and stood up to leave. The middle aged man I met earlier still lay prostrate before my granpa. Silent. Not saying a word. Unknown to me as I drove out of his compound, Granpa's words were about to come alive. I was going to drive right into it when I got to Omole Phase II neighbourhood

24th May 1941
The ship capsized before it reached the Gold Coast. About 200men swam to shore. Yunus Von A was NOT among them.

XXX

Leaving granpa's residence, I drove on for about 30minutes in the dark. The radio in the car hummed slowly. I tuned from station to station until I came across a talkshow. The guest presenter had a strong mega-bass voice and was speaking about the growth of Singapore from a mere British military outpost in the 50s to a first world nation by the 1990s. It's amazing what you can learn from free radio. I forgot about that radio conversation until two years later when I got a gift from Singapore.Here are a few army building tips I picked up. Lee Kuan Yew developed Singapore's economy by a simple economic principle he referred to as "leapfrogging" in his book- **From Third world to First world: The Singapore story: 1965-2000**

Leapfrogging a Nation
Lee Kuan Yew realised that it would require several years to develop the Singaporean economy if they were to build it from the scratch. His administration therefore focused on creating an Economic Development Board filled up with the youngest and brightest Singaporeans whose primary duty was this- to ensure that foreign firms and multi nationals set up their factories and workshops in Singapore. This move would make it easier to create jobs and also to enable the local entrepreneurs arise from previous employees of these multinational firms. Among the firms that set up workshops in Singapore included Hewlett-Packard and Texas Instruments.

The strategy of leapfrogging was what had driven Taiwan's economic and technological rise. Previous employees who had worked at America's silicon valley and top technological firms returned home to Taiwan with their knowledge and expertise of the semi-conductor and micro-chip business. These returnees transplanted the knowledge to create indigenous Taiwanese firms that could compete effectively with American firms in quality of service and standard of technical knowledge.

I would adopt a variant of the strategy few years later.

XXX

The street lights were off and the moon refused to show its face. I drove into Ikorodu road and soon found myself easing off Ojota into Kudirat Abiola way. I was headed for Omole phase two. A few minutes later as I closed in on my destination, the car's left front tire blew out. I navigated the car carefully to a stop and I came out to pick the spare. It too was flat. My carelessness. I was stuck in the middle of the night, a prey to men of the underworld. I could not call my friend. My phone was dead. I glanced down at my wristwatch: 11:45 pm. It was a night I would live to remember.

Evening. 24th May 1941

He awoke with a start on the sandy beach. The whiteman. He awoke. His eyes slowly adjusted to the darkness. His heart skipped a beat. He was surrounded by a dozen of the captives who had been on the boat. One of the men yelled at him angrily in a thick accent-filled dialect. The large thud of a closed fist sounded on his face. He went unconscious, his nose broken and bleeding.

XXX

65 years later. Around Omole Phase Two
I awoke with a start. I had dozed off. I looked around me. My heart skipped a beat. I was surrounded by several mean-looking men carrying what were obviously guns. Strange looking guns.

"Get down", a command rang out.

I opened the door and came down, my knees were knocking against each other. Fear gripped me. I did a quick count. 13 men wielding about 55 guns. Where did these men come from? I asked. Then I saw a face that made me almost pass out. My friend was within their midst. Smiling. He was smiling at me.

XXX

24th May 1941
He awoke again.The night was almost near, the darkness slowly creeped upon the face of the gold coast. Nearby a bonfire was lit and several men were huddled close warming themselves with the heat of fire. He tried to stand but his feet refused to move. He was chained down. Both feet and hands were chained. To two logs. Two heavy logs of wood on both sides. Instinctively he turned his head to the left in the direction of an acrid smell that irritated his nostrils. Then he saw it. And vomited.

XXX

65years later
I looked at my friend as he walked up to me. Bold and confident.
"what is going on?', I asked. He looked at me and smiled. And introduced me to the men. "Dapo, Meet our security team". Security team? These men looked like mercenaries, I thought. Then it hit me. Omole phase Two neighbourhood in Lagos is a secure neighbourhood NOT just because the residents have defensive techniques to dissuade burglars and robbers, but because of their armed-to-the-teeth security team.
Most houses have private guards. It's a neighbourhood that gives an incentive to you to leave it alone in peace. But it was not always that way. Few years earlier, the neighbourhoood had had its own share of robberies and "funny" incidents until a resolve was made by the residents to pray to GOD but also protect themselves
against attack. You could say that Omole Phase Two has raised itsown army. But they were NOT the first as granpa would later let me
know. Someone had beaten them to it several centuries before.

26th May 1941
The whiteman recoiled again at the sight pegged beside the logs of wood. The heads of his giants were placed on stakes and hammered into the beach in a circle around him. The captives, now free were discussing close to the fire. What Nobody saw was the body that washed up ashore just a few metres away. A body that would save the whiteman's life. At least for a very short while.

XXX

The next weekend, I returned back to granpa and we sat down to continue our discussions. we had some small chit chat- usual granpa/grandson gist and then the basics The Basics
"You need to find a better way to navigate to success. What I am about to discuss with you will infuse you with the notion to reform the world. Let us begin", my granpa said I powered up my laptop, logged in my password and started typing"Let's go over the basics", he said
1.Identity
granpa said,"the very first battle you will fight is identity""and what do you mean by identity", I asked."By identity, I mean that you know exactly who you are. You don't have to live your life the way other people expect you to. You don't have to seek permission or approval to be yourself. You design the life you desire", he said "You will fight this battle of identity alone . You can NOT lead a nation if you are afraid to stand out. You must assert your identity and make a decision to live a remarkable life", he continued" a remarkable life?", I asked "yes, a remarkable life. A life that others will pass remarks about. By choosing to stand out, you will become a target for critics and cynics who will believe they understand you and pass all sorts of remarks on your motivation"

"Granpa, I'm not sure if criticism is something i'll enjoy attracting. I like my privacy and I prefer people should mind their business", I replied

"When you make the decision to stand out, Ibidapo, Mark my words- you WILL face criticism. Your business will automatically become everyone's business. Haven't you noticed how people enjoy criticising public figures even when they can't do any better than them. However, this decision to stand out will enable you live your life and experience the exhiliriation of a lifetime of adventure", he said

"But it hurts when people criticise and judge you", I said
\
"Yes it does. But who is the final Judge?"

"what?"

who is the final Judge?"
"The Judge is God", I replied

"Perfect Ibidapo... Perfect answers. You speak well... When you stand before God on Judgement day, he won't cross examine your opponent over your decisions. It will just be YOU. "

Remember I decided to stand out on the shores of that coast. It saved my life and saved several others. YOU will have to make the decision to stand out and be remarkable. If you are afraid to stand out, you are not worthy of leadership. No one will make that decision for you. Are you ready to stand out and live a remarkable life?

2.Take a Stand
There is one essential trait of all great leaders, they polarise people. They force you to take sides either against them or for them. You know EXACTLY where they stand. Remember when the son of Nun said-,"choose this day whom you will serve.."Today's world is earnestly looking for leaders who will challenge conventional thinking. When you declare where you stand, your opponents will emerge. So also will your army. But always remember- your opponent is just a mere dissident to the life of purpose you've chosen to live.

3. A compelling vision
If you think people are motivated by money alone, think again. In your emerging world,people are beginning to see the futility of chasing after money and forgetting to live a life. The reason why people like Adedibu existed is because they gave their followers a very compelling vision that money alone could not buy....'Ibidapo, what is your compelling vision?"

4. Power of words
The greatest weapons you have in building your army are words. In building your army, you will need to employ your tongue to convince people and conquer territories... You've been groomed by my son (your father) to use strong passion-filled words. Now you need to regroom yourself. Ibidapo, you must be conscious of our words, the quality of everything must be put into words...Words become flesh. Kingdoms have been toppled by words and built by words... It is by divine design that words have become life....

If you can NOT address people and give them hope, give them a future, then you should cover your head in shame. How then will you hope to inspire them or lead them? Which leads me to ask you one simple question-

"How do most political leaders get people to vote for them?" I thought for a minute. Then it occurred to me. "they campaign..." I replied "Yes. They speak to people. They debate their opponents. The only way most people can assess your leadership ability is by your public speaking skills. That's why politicians have to debate one another and the best public speaker in most societies is often seen as a better leader. This means even if you are a very competent leader BUT you do NOT know how to speak up in public, people will see NOT see you as a very good leader. They will NOT follow you. All remarkable leaders can MOVE a crowd with their words. But this is enough. Next time, we will discuss persuasion strategies. But note that those strategies should only be used with the noblest of motives otherwise it will smack of manipulation. When next we see, we'll discuss that in detail. Then you'll be ready to take on the next challenge.."

"Which is..." "the challenge of Gaa, the spirit of tyranny..." I never saw grandpa again until 6 months after.

27th May 1941
Morning.Hunger has a way of making men fight over the smallest of issues. This morning, it had been a barrel of corn that had washed ashore from the sea. They had quibbled over the issue of rations. Who would eat and who would be left out. The light skinned men who found the barrel wanted it voted to their tribesmen. This provoked anger from those who had killed the giants. They pointed out thatthey had ensured the freedom of everyone on the shore. The quarrel was growing fierce and several tiny groups had formed. Each group was speaking in anger and issues threats in their native dialects. Then someone noticed the body. The body moved. Everyone hushed.
And turned towards the body. The body coughed. It would take an half-dead man to stop a corn-quarrel on the coasts of gold.
XXX
45 years later
DMA head office
I had sat down at my desk doodling imagining having a vacation on fiji. The week had filled with so much activity and I was slightly exhausted. This was my way of letting steam. At least if I couldn't travel to fiji in person, I could go there in my mind.I powered up my laptop and browsed halfheartedly through my documents until I came across a granpa.txt file. I opened it out of curiousity and was amazed at what I had typed down. I had not gone over it since we had last seen. Then I remembered the conversation like it had been yesterday The art of PERSUASION wHEN PEOPLE LIKE YOU, THEY WILL THINK THE BEST OF YOU. WHEN THEY HATE YOU, THEY WILL SEE ONLY YOUR FAULTS.

"The strategies I want to tell you will be easy to understand but difficult to execute. Hence the saying: One may know how to conquer without being able to do it." he said

I agreed with him. It is possible to know how a surgery is done without being able to perform the procedure.Theory and practical skills are two different things.

"But if you learn to execute these strategies, almost NOTHING will be impossible for you. No man will be able to withstand you, ever. In all you do, you will succeed. These strategies can be summed up in three words- Never Eat Alone."

Never eat alone?Yes. Never eat alone. This has been the secret of successful African leaders- both the good and the evil ones. They never eat alone. In ancient Yoruba culture, a meal was not just a meal. A meal was a ritual, a daily sacrifice, a forum to share and keep influence. Sharing a meal has been the key to success and influence. That's the reason why your father's generation and mine attend all those parties and public functions.

"Granpa, those parties are just an extravagant waste of wealth. The funds people spend could be used to drive our nations development""It's just that the purpose has been corrupted.At the beginning, it was not so. Earlier on, social functions were the medium through which chiefs and Kings would mingle with their people and hear their opinions on how to lead the tribe. Today, africans attend parties to waste their wealth rather than build influence with which they can drive great societal change." granpa said

"That's a key strategy I think Adedibu learnt from Bashorun Gaa"
he continued

"Bashorun Gaa?" I echoed

"Yes. Bashorun Gaa, the kingmaker and prime minister of the ancient Oyo Empire. He was known to have enthroned five successive Alaafins (Kings) and orchestrated the death of four of them. He was himself killed in an insurrection led by the fifth Alaafin. He was diabolical. I'm sure even the devil was afraid of him. But he had something going for him all before his death"

"And what was that granpa?", I asked

He didn't reply. Granpa stood up and walked into his bedroom. I heard the sound of rummaging and searching. What was granpa up to? He returned ten minutes later with a joyful grin on his face. He dropped a dusty old book on his centre table. The book landed with a thud. I picked it up and dusted the cover. It read- The History of the Yorubas by Rev. Samuel Johnson.

Granpa spoke up," You want to know what he had going for him? Then you'll just have to go into the history of our tribe. But know this-When a man with evil intents combines wealth with influence, it is like letting a plague loose on the entire community. Such a man becomes like a rabid dog that strikes everything in his way.
You will meet men like that in your quest for global significance. .You can not reason with such men or use moral arguements to convince them. You will need God and influence to stop them. But first, you have to understand them and to do that, you need to know Gaa.
I had no choice but to read up on Gaa. .....That's when I
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27th May 1941
Off the shores of the Gold coast

A bold middle-aged dark skinned man had approached the body with caution. It called for real caution. It had been three whole days after they had swam to shore. How could anyone have survived two days at sea without food and freshwater?, they had all thought. The bold man had walked over and turned the body carefully. Then the face that several men would come to respect came into view. It was the face of Yunus Von A. He was "chinese"- he couldn't die that easily.

According to Yoruba folklore, The day after Gaa was born, Ajanaku (his father) had summoned his diviners to determine whose footsteps the child traced to the world, what orisa (god) he should worship when he became of age , and what he would become in future.Ejiogbe was the odu that appeared on Ifa. The parents were asked to sacrifice eight thousand cowries and a fowl.

The Babalawo (herbalist) sang the oriki (praise song) of the odu, reminding all present that when a rich man dies, his money goes to waste, when a noble dies, his wealth fades but remember ye, the traces of he who leaves children in this world are never erased.

The child (Gaa) would become a personage of consequence in the city and entire Yorubaland, till eterity and would be blessed with many children. Further divination showed that he would worship Sango (the Yoruba god of thunder). The odu that brought this was Okanran Meji.

(Odu- riddle or story denoted by a particular configuration of the opele or sixteen stringed nuts of divination said in form of a poem which can only be interpreted by one learned in the Ifa compendium.)

A child who will answer Asamu, samu-samu must his mouth be sharp from infancy. True to prognosis, Gaa had from infancy exhibited the tendency to be great. His arrival seemed to herald into the house of Ajanaku a flood of male children in quick succession. He was indeed a leader, and it was insinuated by some, with unfaltering belief that this child's desire to be in the lead whenever he came to the world must have occasioned his blocking the path of others who would have come before him. He was a leader right from heaven.

Still his father never relented in his effort to prepare him for the position of leadership he envisaged for him. For as the saying goes, it is with your hand that you fine tune your destiny. When Gaa was four, a memory stimulating preparation made of cock's crown, a whole hen, bananas, roast yam, alligator pepper and a corn cob was boiled for him, which he ate in a night. He became, apart from being strong-willed, also a precocious youth of sharp memory and intelligence that was far ahead of his age. He was NOT only destined to lead but in his father's thinking, he was prepared to lead. But childhood advantage alone was NOT the key to his evil infuence. He acquired the keys in a way you would never have imagined.
(I do NOT endorse pagan practices here. I only report the stories)

30th May 1941
Early Morning

The Men woke up and the first agenda for the day were corn rations. A fight was brewing and this time, there were no more bodies to break up the fight. As voices grew louder and tempers waxed stronger, a voice rang out with authority."Divide equal portions for everyone. All men are equal here. This is NOT a warship. This is the coast of no man's land".They all looked at the owner of the voice. It was Yunus Von A. Nobody dared question the wisdom of the words spoken. Besides, there was a brewing legend that this man was NOT human. They had begun to percieve him as a demi-god. How else could they explain his survival. Yunus Von A. would not diabuse their minds of that explanation.

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Bashorun Gaa had been very diabolical, but he made use of certain social norms to enhance his standing in the community. He was known to throw feasts and organise events that left the entire town singing of his generosity. He was able to gather the support of the Oyo mesi by giving out gifts that came from war proceeds. He also tied down his ambitions to the success of others by pointing out what they stood to gain. However, one principle he made use of was what Jesus had preached about years before him. It would take my granpa to point it out almost 2 years after our first discussion. And granpa's phrase- never eat alone. I tried to put it into practice and failed miserably. I ended up with high restaurant bills and no influence. It was then I decided to give up. We never discussed the issue until several months later

2years later. Inside a traffic Jam

My phone rang.Caller I.d.- Granpa

"Hello Granpa, what a pleasant surprise", I said

He didn't call me often. There were things that I never expected from granpa, phone calls were one of them. And I knew something was up. This HAD to be important.

His first question:

"Your army...?", he started
"My what...?"
"Your army. Have you started putting an army together?", he asked
I gasped.

"The battle of your age will not be fought to gain territories but to wield influence over the minds of men," he continued
"Are you preparing an army for that battle?"

I was silent. My granpa had just started sounding like a prophet.

Granpa..." I started

Ibidapo, listen. Just listen! " his voice cut through my excuse like a bullet cutting through a sheet of paper.

My age is passing. My court makes no sense in your days. But this I know, the more influence you have, the easier it will be to empower those who will need it. You need to understand that the wealth of your day will NOT be reward for Hard Work alone. More importantly, it will be reward for Influence. A lesson I learned early in life, the influential have more resources to work with than others. The only advantage I can give you is the wisdom that I have acquired over the years- it all boils down to influence.

"Granpa, your ideas are difficult to execute. I have failed at them. I mean- never eat alone? It's easier said than done. Also there's the grey line between corruption and influence. It can be a very dirty game trying to build influence with some of your Suggestions. I don't want to be caught in between.", I said

"learn how to..."

"how to what"

"learn how to acquire influence. All the great generals and warriors of the ages past knew that influence is founded on two simple laws. One of them is reciprocity. The second is what South Africans refer to as "ubuntu".

“ubuntu?" I repeated. That was the name of a Linux operating system.

Reciprocity
When you do favours for people ahead of time, you will have created a link that will enable you access to them later. It is called, “I scratch your back, you scratch mine. Jesus called it **the golden rule.** That's why the English have a phrase when you do them a favour. They respond with, “I am very much obliged”. Doing people favours creates an obligation. Before you get anything, always think of what value you can add to others. It builds influence. It worked for Bashorun Gaa. Just Make sure it doesn't work against you. The Yoruba have an adage that says that, *“If you pour water ahead of you, you will tread on wet ground”* Do NOT let people buy you with reciprocity. But use it to develop influence *only* for noble purposes.

Ubuntu
The South African principle of **ubuntu** states that, “The only way for me to be human is for you to reflect my humanity back at me. What **ubuntu** really says is that there is no way for us to be human without other people...”
"You can steel your heart against any kind of horror or any kind of danger, but the simple kind act of a complete stranger will unstitch you. Learn my grandson. Learn and become influential. Do people favours without expecting any returns. It is another key to influence. Let's see this week end" and the phone went dead

XXX

Weekend. Granpas's Residence
I had explained to him how I had burned a hole in my budget trying to apply his principles and granpa laughed. Then he spoke:

Life is a war. **A war of influence**. Everyone claims to hate politics but we all play politics. We all do. Whether in corporate life or in church or in our families, we all try to influence and persuade people. .

Two Immutable Decisions
In today's world, 80% of your success in life will depend on other people. Therefore there are just two choices before: Either you influence them OR you don't. There's no middle ground. If you fail to influence people, you have made a choice. But then you can't complain when either of the two outcomes occurs

“What outcomes?”,I asked.

There are just two possible outcomes: Either Influence is used in your favour OR against you. When you see evil men on the rise and you can't stop them or counter them because they are too influential, then it will dawn on you. Influence takes on the character of the person who possesses it. Remember Bashorun Gaa- he killed people recklessly, his first son Kanna-kanna, raped women on their wedding nights and nobody could stop him for a long while. "Okay. I'm back in the game. I will choose to lead. I will choose to develop influence and use it for noble reasons"

"When you make that decision to develop influence, it will boil down to one logical conclusion.."

"which is...",I asked

Granpa did not answer. He just stood up to go ease himself. When he returned, he held a copy of the Guardian.

Nuhu Ribadu, the ex-EFCC (Economic and Financial Crimes Commission) boss was on the front cover. He sat down and continued speaking."Have you been following the news recently?", he asked me

"No", I replied. The stress of running a Media and marketing firm on a lowkey budget coupled with preparing for professional exams didn't afford me time to read newspapers as regularly as I should have.

Pointing to Mallam Nuhu Ribadu on the front cover, he said," this is a good example of a man who didn't build his own army despite the fact that he was a policeman and he was chairman of the Economic and Financial Crimes Commission. He forgot that a war on corruption is exactly what it means- A war.And there's one thing which I can assure you from my short experience as a soldier- in a war, the other side will fight back- and they won't always follow the rules of engagement. They'll fight dirty, if they think they're losing."

"But he was doing the right thing", I cut in

"omode lo n se e", he replied. "Nuhu Ribadu was doing the right thing but he forgot to fight the war the right way. When you go to war against any nation, you must have assessed whether you have enough troops and allies to win the war before embarking on the war effort. Sometimes you might even have to ally with a lesser enemy to get rid of a greater enemy. Learn from this- Nuhu Ribadu was prosecuting people who stole billions, it should have occured to him that nobody can spend billions of naira alone. The person did NOT eat the billions alone." "that's true", I nodded in agreement.

So when you throw the person who stole the billions into prison, what do you think his army that he fed with the stolen funds will do?" he asked
"they'll fight back", I replied

"that's right. So I want you to learn this lesson: wherever you find yourself, start building your army of relationships because you can never tell when you would need them to act on your behalf. If there's anything i've learnt during my years on earth, this is it-sooner or later you will always need an army. Then he answered his previous question.

"When you make that decision to develop influence, it will boil
down to one logical conclusion..."

"The rise of your own army"

June 1941

Yunus Von A. looked at the men who stood and waited for the words he would speak. They wanted to kill the whiteman but he had a different idea. He let him go. If others were wicked enough to enslave men to fight for their freedom, he would show a better way. he would break the cycle of pain. He looked up into the skies and prayed that God would take them all home safely. God had no intention of answering the prayers.

XXX
A few days after Saturday Morning I was at my parents home having a morning devotion with my father when we delved into discussing Influence. We had spoken at length. Finally my father said,

"there's one character who you need to study his military
Strategy" who?

"Israel's first general and military strategist"

Joshua, the son of nun. Sort of an ancient day Arnold Schwarzeneggar.

I knew Joshua. Since sunday school days. Then you'll know that your granpa left something critical out. Read your bible, go online and do some research on Joshua. You'll find some shocking details. He was brutal.I'm sure he was even worse than Bashorun Gaa. His army started the middle east crisis which persisted till today. And the one which all christians and jews miss- he wasn't even human.

XXX
I just finished reading the book of Joshua the third time and then it dawned on me. I had the answer. It was a phrase that was repeated throughout chapter one of the book of joshua. It was a phrase I would need several times in my life as I tried to expand my circle of Influence. It is a phrase for you. Check Chapter 1 verse 6,7,8 and 18. It was what all great leaders would need to possess. But there was more. I would discover when I next I had a morning devotion with my father.
XXX

What My Granpa left out which is causing a lot of trouble today. Two weeks afterSaturday Breakfast in My Father's house
There is something your granpa left out. I don't want you to forget.

We covered almost all the logical options Dad. I don't think he
missed anything out.
Yes he did. Or perhaps he said it but you overlooked it.
what Dad?

There is a deficit in hearing from God so that people are being forced to build their armies independent of God. A strong relationship with God comes first... You need to understand what God is saying... If you don't build the relationship first, you will fight wars you don't need to. Pray to God to teach you how to have faith in him and walk with him.

Dad, I understand", I said. "No you don't. I have watched you grow from childhood. I have witnessed your choleric tendencies and seen you become a Man. I see your driveness to achieve and become. I've seen you lead your siblings, your firm and social organisations and believe me, this is the most important key to influence. Miss this and you've missed everything.

Are you telling me to give up these dreams of global influence. No, I'm Not. If God gave you a dream, he will power it. even till your hairs turn grey, he has made you and will bear you up. That is GOd taking responsibility for your efforts. That's where most people miss it There is a spirit in man and the inspiration of the almighty gives him understanding. The rise of your army starts with one person- Not even you- therise of your own army starts with GOD.

In the beginning-God....

A man that moves and walks with God's vision never dies unknown. You seek global significance? It all starts with one force- God.
I had to speak carefully. This conversation was a test of my wits. "Dad, This was the reason I came into the world. It was for this reason I was born. I want to reform the African continent. I want to find and equip African superheroes one after the other. I want to go down in history with the likes of Winston Churchill, Mahatma Gandhi and Nelson Mandela. I want to push Nigeria to First World Status.

"Ibidapo, Are you ready to go all the way out for this purpose even if you're unknown... Are you ready?"

"you want the truth Dad, I'm not sure. I have seen what fame can do. I have seen it corrupt men. I have also seen that famous men find it easier executing projects. I know that fame and influence are key marketing strategies. I know what it takes. I think I am willing to pay the price. I want to reform the African continent. I know it begins with God.

This discussion was my turning point. It was why I attended the DLA leadership course. The rise of your army, your ambitions starts and ends with one person- Not even you.

Let me add three more words to the title of this chapter The rise of your own army ...starts with God.

Yunus Von A. and his band had moved into the heart of the town. The men were hungry and thirsty. The previous night, they had all shared seven fishes and a grain of corn each. They would have to plunder a neighbourhood and trade their souls for a morsel of fuufuuu. They would also need to find a way of getting back home. But not until they took part in the african version of World War II

XXX
What I learnt about Influence and you too should
1.GOD
If you're like me and you've got great dreams, Don't kill it. take it to him and get his acknowledgement. If he gave you the dream, you'll get the resources to fund it. That includes the relationships. You need a GodForce ahead of you to take all the blows otherwise you'll end up sacrificing your relationships for worthless causes. I've been there. I've done that.

2. Network.
No man is an Island. There are resources available with people close to you. All you have to do is harness them.

3. Do people favours.
Connect people to succes. Linkthem to those who can make their dreams come true. In the long run, your circle of influence would have expanded

4. Become visible
Do not be afraid to have a public face. Influence can be a key marketing strategy.

5. Perfect your public speaking skills
Your leadership skills will often be assessed by public speaking. Log onto www.superheroes.co.nr for details on our next public speaking workshop.Also there's alliance for change empowerment speakers-their workshops hold every second sunday . log onto www.acesnigeria.com for details

6.Attend events and workshops. It doesn't have to be lavish but ensure that you and others can build meaningful relationships from meeting at such forums

7. Here's my personal favorite: Never eat alone. I don't say this to mean corrupt practices. I mean sharing a meal or dinner with someone can go a long way to help you cement a meaningful relationship

8. Prepare for variable change.Opportunities will arise that will enable you take the lead. Seize them. Mine was setting up my audience brokering firm with a partner, leading within my family, governing the 2009 DLA CLASS and leading the early phases of the superheroes network. Yours is here. Seize it and grow.

Trends that will soon hit us
1. Wealth will go towards influence than hard work alone. In future, people will make money by mining their influence brand than by actual work. If you don't believe me, I

have just one word- D'Banj

2. Word of Mouth Advertising will drive sales of products than actual tv and radio advertising.
3. Members of social networks will get ahead faster than isolated individuals. Which is easier? To sell to someone who was introduced by a friend or to sell to an outright stranger. Besides, network members get access to a wider range of information than others.

4. The internet is changing the nature of social media. Facebook, linkedIn, superheros- I guess you get my drift

5. Armies will rule NOT individuals.
6. Those who teach how to produce will make more than those who produce. Just accept this fact. I'll pause the trends here.

What should you do

1. Attend a leadership course
I decided to attend the Daystar leadership Academy this year. I was elected class governor and got to leapfrog and co-ordinate a network from within the members of my leadership class- the superheroes network. You too should attend DLA. The impact the leadership training had on me was like strapping a jet engine to
an okada. I almost blew up.

2. Join a network.
you'll get to meet people from various walks of life that can provide advice on career and businesschallenges. Our network- the superheroes network has several plans and events lined up for the next one year and the participation and involvement of all the superheroes here has been very overwhelming. Here are career professionals from industries like banking, oil and gas, marketing, You don't know what it means to work side by side with over a thousand career professionals who are destined for global Significance.

3. Read Dozens of leadership books. In the words of John C.
Maxwell, everything rises and falls on leadership. I have several ebooks on leadership, management (about 400 of them).I'd be more than willing to share them with you. Just give me a call.

4.Unleash the ideas within this book by giving this chapter away free. You can help create awareness for the projects our superheroes network is executing:-Download free copies of this chapter from www.superheroes.co.nr and share with people
- Give this copy with you away to at least 4people to read- Support the publishing of more copies of subsequent chapters- Invite any member of our leadership team to give a presentation at your conference. Visit www.superheroes.co.nr

5.Partner with members of the superheroes network. there are presently a thousand members of superheroes. About 100 of them require venture capital to fund their businesses. if you have funds and you'd like to develop this nation, call me 07094084776 (evenings Tuesday -thursday) and I'll link you with great minds that will put your funds to great use. I forgot to mention, I won't bill you middleman fees (smiles)

6. Influence audiences- Seed Remarkable ideas. here's where I get to advertise my firm. We influence audiences by seeding remarkable ideas. You too should.

Let's start again.

June 11, 2009
Eventually, I succeeded in putting an army of superheroes together. It was just in time for my next dream.

The Outskirts of Nowhere

I was back within the boardroom standing awaiting the voice I now knew as that of the great architect of the universe.After waiting for what seemed like eternity, I spoke out as respectfully as my tone would allow. "Sir, what next? I have followed your instructions and put together a network of over a thousand 1,000 people, that's four times the 256people you adviced me about. How next do we proceed? What next do we do?"

You'll need to equip each of them. Give them the resources they need to bring about my gameplanfor Nigeria""how do I do that?",I asked "Talk to your granpa, he knows exactly how you'll equip them," the awesome voice responded you'll be needing billions to lead your movement. And he knows exactly where you'll find it.

I awoke in my bed again. This was no dream. This was reality. I now lead an army- a network of superheroes. All with advantages, capabilities and abilities beyond my wildest dreams. One thousand and sixteen of them. They also lead me. Then it dawned on me. I have powers I never dreamt of. I can do things I never imagined I could. There are no limitations except those of my mind. I am NOW a superhero. And guess what- so are you. Just keep MOVING forward.

sneak preview

After you put your army together, the next task is money. You need to get financing together. About how much financing? I asked 'Well, going by what I just read in today's papers, you need just a little over 16 billion naira, granpa said smiling.

16 billion?, I gasped. Yes, you are going to get 16billion naira, the man who sat in granpa's livingroom said. I laughed. " Sir, How...?' You will get it the old fashioned way. the old fashioned way?

"yes, you're going to steal it..."

I burst out laughing until I saw the serious glint in the man's eyes..

I looked away from him towards my granpa

"steal it? surely granpa, this man can't be serious. I'm NOT a thief", I said I looked at him again. Then at my granpa. Granpa shook his head and motioned me to let the man finish I looked at the man again.

"you're serious", i asked

He nodded.

And who will I steal N16billion from? Dangote?

No Not Dangote. You'll withdraw it from a bank

which bank?

The only Bank that will give you whatever you want without flinching-
and what bank is that?

You're going to rob World Bank.

Superheroes:How to steal N16billion naira

coming Nov 5th 2009.Download from www.superheroes.co.nr. The story just continued.